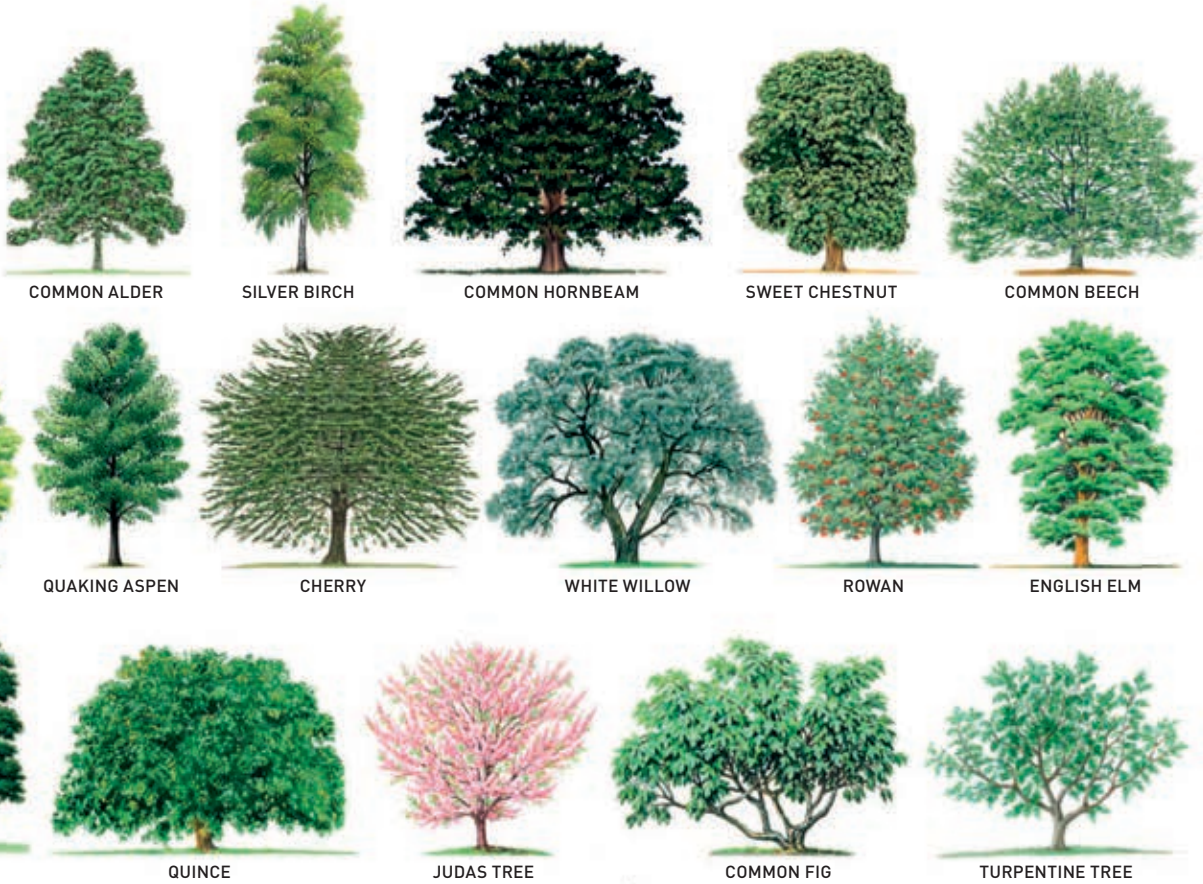


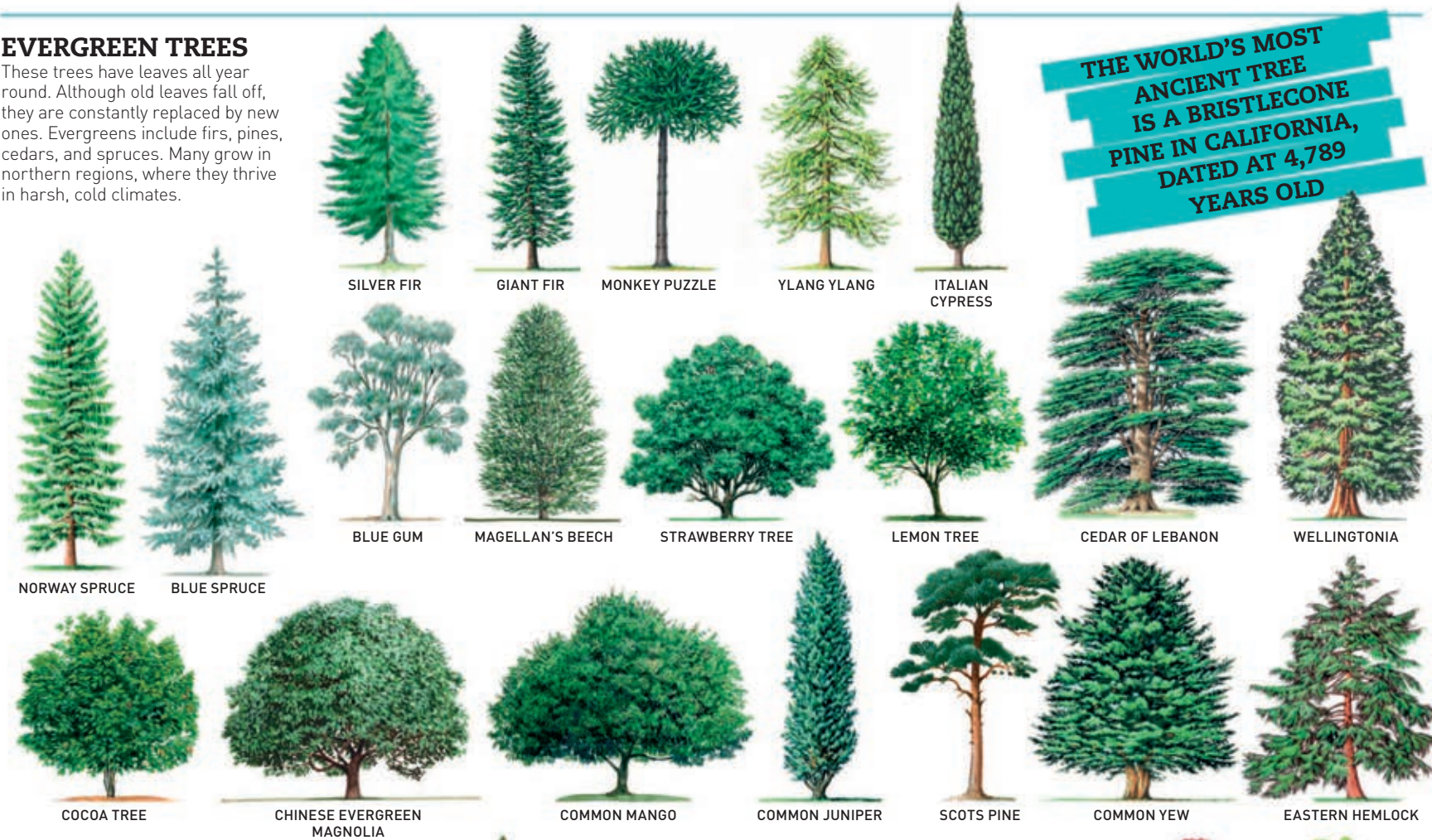
DECIDUOUS TREES

Trees that lose all their leaves for part of the year – for example, oaks and beeches – are called deciduous. They have flat leaves of many shapes that are usually shed in cold or dry seasons. The tree remains bare until warmer weather returns, when new leaves grow. Deciduous trees are found in many regions of the world.



EVERGREEN TREES

These trees have leaves all year round. Although old leaves fall off, they are constantly replaced by new ones. Evergreens include firs, pines, cedars, and spruces. Many grow in northern regions, where they thrive in harsh, cold climates.



ANCIENT TREES

The first tree-like plants that grew on Earth, about 380 million years ago, were spore trees. These reproduced not from seeds but from cells called spores on the underside of their leaves. The only spore trees living today are the tree ferns. Another ancient tree is the Ginkgo, a survivor from before the age of dinosaurs.



BONSAI

The ancient oriental art of bonsai creates tiny replicas of large trees. Techniques such as wiring roots and branches stop the tree from reaching its full growth. Bonsai can be used on any type of tree to produce a miniature version small enough to keep in a pot.

